their traditional occupations of farming and animal husbandry, without the constant fear of being killed by a stray shell or bullet. Tourism, the mainstay of the economy, would flourish only if there were no terrorist incidents. Something, therefore, needed to be done. During this same period, our Commanders on ground received a few feelers during the scheduled flag meetings for some kind of a limited understanding at the local level to restrict trans-LC firings. This was responded to by saying that while not averse to such an idea, a matter of such import should be broached at the DGMO level in the telephonic talks that are held every Tuesday. These overtures were also informed to the NSA, Shri Ajit Doval. These backroom discussions continued for a while, finally culminating in an 'Understanding' to restore the ceasefire agreement of 2003. In a joint statement, India and Pakistan agreed to a 'strict observance of all agreements, understandings and cease firing along the Line of Control (LoC) and all other sectors' with effect from midnight, February 24/25. The decision was announced after discussions between the Director Generals of Military Operations (DGsMO) over the established hotline.[8]

However, it was clarified in no uncertain terms, that this applied only to firings between military post and military post. We reserved the right to fire on any suspicious movement astride the LC and in the gaps between posts. Our CI/CT posture was not compromised in any manner following the ceasefire, which was honoured and is still holding out. There was a drastic drop in the number of civilian and security forces casualties. Infiltration attempts, however, continued, but they were fewer in number and more vulnerable to detection, interception and elimination, now that they were without the covering fire traditionally given by Pakistani posts. February turned out to be a good month for us. First the disengagement

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